

Arthur Alberto Cardoso Reis
Felipe Gomes Rodrigues Dos Santos
Kil Matheus Gomes Teixeira
Leandro de Oliveira Custodio

Flare Dynamic Art

GED TRAIL TO ELENKI

SÃO PAULO
2025

Arthur Alberto Cardoso Reis
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Kil Matheus Gomes Teixeira
Leandro de Oliveira Custodio

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GED TRAIL TO ELENKI

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Epigraph

O coração tem razões que a própria
razão desconhece.

Blaise Pascal, Pensées

Resumo

REIS, Arthur Alberto Cardoso; SANTOS, Felipe Gomes Rodrigues dos; TEIXEIRA, Kil Matheus Gomes; CUSTODIO, Leandro de Oliveira. **Trail to Elenki**. 2025. 16 f. TCC (Graduação em **Ciência da Computação, Engenharia de Software e Engenharia da Computação**) – Instituto de Tecnologia e Liderança, São Paulo, 2025.

O presente trabalho apresenta a estruturação da startup FLARE Dynamic Art e o planejamento para seu futuro lançamento conjunto com um jogo autoral independente (*indie*), focado em experiências filosóficas e emocionais. O objetivo central foi consolidar as bases operacionais e estratégicas do empreendimento antes de sua entrada no mercado. O escopo do projeto abrangeu o desenvolvimento técnico do Produto Mínimo Viável (MVP) na *engine* Godot, integrando arte e programação, aliado a uma profunda estruturação de negócios. Foram realizados estudos detalhados de custos, despesas e estimativas tributárias para a análise financeira, bem como a elaboração de estratégias de marketing e de uma proposta de valor voltada para investidores. A validação do modelo de negócios e do produto ocorreu por meio de banca especializada e testes com usuários. Os *feedbacks* obtidos confirmaram a viabilidade do projeto, fundamentando o plano para o lançamento simultâneo da empresa e de seu primeiro título.

Palavras-Chave: Empreendedorismo; Jogos Indie; Análise Financeira; Godot; Plano de Negócios.

ABSTRACT

REIS, Arthur Alberto Cardoso; SANTOS, Felipe Gomes Rodrigues dos; TEIXEIRA, Kil Matheus Gomes; CUSTODIO, Leandro de Oliveira. **Trail to Elenki**. 2025. 16 p. Final Course Project (Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science, Software Engineering, and Computer Engineering) – Institute of Technology and Leadership, São Paulo, 2025.

This work presents the structuring of the startup FLARE Dynamic Art and the planning for its future launch alongside an independent (indie) authorial game, focused on philosophical and emotional experiences. The central objective was to consolidate the operational and strategic bases of the venture before its market entry. The project scope covered the technical development of the Minimum Viable Product (MVP) in the Godot engine, integrating art and programming, combined with a deep business structuring. Detailed studies of costs, expenses, and tax estimates were conducted for financial analysis, as well as the elaboration of marketing strategies and a value proposal aimed at investors. The validation of the business model and the product occurred through a specialized panel and user tests. The feedback obtained confirmed the project's feasibility, grounding the plan for the simultaneous launch of the company and its first title.

Keywords: Entrepreneurship; Indie Games; Financial Analysis; Godot; Business Plan.

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1. INTRODUCTION

Strategic planning is a structured process that organizations use to define their direction and make informed decisions about allocating resources to achieve their goals. It involves setting a clear mission, vision, and core values, which establish the organization's purpose, principles, and long-term aspirations, ensuring alignment between objectives and daily operations.

Additionally, strategic planning includes a market analysis, which examines industry trends, audience demographics, and competitors to identify opportunities and challenges. The business model definition is another key aspect, as it determines how the organization creates, delivers, and captures value, shaping its revenue streams and operational approach.

As organizations grow, they must also plan for scalability and expansion, ensuring sustainable development by adapting to new markets, technologies, and consumer needs. By integrating these elements, strategic planning helps organizations anticipate market trends, adapt to challenges, and maintain a competitive advantage.

1.1 ORGANIZATIONAL IDENTITY

The strategic planning of Flare Dynamic Art defines the fundamental pillars that guide our decisions and drive the organization's growth. Through our mission, vision, and values, we establish a commitment to excellence in game development, ensuring innovation, quality, and an immersive experience for our players.

1.1.1 Mission

Our mission is to culturally enrich Brazil and the world by democratizing access to knowledge and encouraging critical reflection on society. We believe that exploring history, philosophy, sociology, and contemporary issues should be an engaging experience, capable of sparking questions and expanding perspectives.

But we want to do this in a unique way: combining art and technology to create innovative experiences that transcend traditional teaching. Our games are not

just educational tools but interactive narratives that challenge the way people learn and think. Through immersive stories, thought-provoking mechanics, and a provocative approach, we aim to transform learning into an intense and stimulating intellectual journey.

We want every experience within our games to be an invitation to questioning and discovery, making learning an enjoyable, challenging, and transformative process.

1.1.2 Vision

Our vision is to be a reference in innovation and disruption in cultural education, redefining the way people learn and interact with knowledge. We aim to create a learning environment that is accessible, dynamic, and stimulating, where critical thinking and creativity are fueled by immersive and meaningful experiences.

We will do this without following rigid formulas, without fear of being bold, and without compromising our authenticity. We believe that education can be a sensory and artistic experience, which is why we combine art and technology to build something unique.

We want to be more than a learning platform. Our goal is to inspire a generation that not only absorbs information but deeply analyzes it, understanding the historical, social, and philosophical contexts that shape the present and future.

By integrating technology, innovation, and impactful narratives, we aspire to create a lasting impact on education, making learning a continuous and transformative process. More than a pedagogical resource, we want to be a catalyst for change, sparking a passion for knowledge and encouraging a culture of critical thinking and solid argumentation.

1.1.3 Values

- **Critical Thinking**

We believe that questioning is essential for a more enlightened and democratic society. We value the in-depth analysis of multiple perspectives

and encourage debates that challenge common sense. Our games are designed to provoke reflections and foster dialogues that break away from superficial views.

- **Creativity**

Learning doesn't have to be monotonous. We create engaging and provocative experiences where creativity becomes an essential element in the construction of knowledge. Our language is art: we use striking visuals, immersive soundtracks, and innovative mechanics to make each game a unique sensory experience.

- **Innovation**

We are always seeking new ways to teach, learn, and interact with knowledge. We combine cutting-edge technology with creative storytelling to provide transformative experiences. For us, educational innovation goes beyond traditional methods, bringing dynamic, immersive, and impactful approaches.

- **Social Impact**

Our commitment goes beyond entertainment. We want to be agents of transformation, promoting accessible and inclusive learning that broadens horizons and creates new opportunities. We believe in the power of knowledge to transform realities and inspire individuals to become protagonists of their own stories.

- **Curiosity**

We value intellectual restlessness and the relentless pursuit of answers. We want to awaken in players the desire to explore, question, and continuously learn. We believe that a better world is built with curious minds, willing to delve into knowledge and discover new possibilities.

- **Authenticity**

We don't follow conventional standards. We create our own path, blending art, technology, and knowledge to offer something truly original. We avoid the obvious and always strive to challenge expectations.

With this foundation, we aim not only to entertain but also to educate and provoke deep reflections about the world we live in, contributing to a more conscious and culturally enriched future.

1.2 Market Analysis

The indie game industry has been going through a phase of rapid growth and professionalization since 2024, both in Brazil and worldwide, with record production and sales figures, as well as shifts in the competitive landscape. The indie market has become a driving force of innovation, attracting investment, new talent, and the attention of traditional players, while also facing unique challenges related to supply, demand, and long-term sustainability.

1.2.1 Overview of the Indie Market

In 2024, indie games accounted for around 48% of Steam's total revenue—almost matching AAA and AA titles in value—and generated over USD 3.98 billion in sales by September, with projected growth of 82% by the end of the year.

The number of indie titles released hit an all-time high: around 16,000 on Steam in 2024 alone, with further growth expected in 2025.

In Brazil, the indie segment is growing above the industry average, driven by government incentives, new sources of investment (such as the Google Indie Games Fund), and the expansion of the player base.

1.2.2 Competitors and Segmentation

The indie market is segmented by size and performance: “Triple-I Indies” (larger studios with polished products, such as Supergiant), “Middle Market,” “Small Teams,” and “Hobbyists.”

- Roughly the top 8% of indie games account for 80% of the revenue; hits are rare, but they can be highly profitable.
- Notable studios known for strong narratives and innovative mechanics include Supergiant Games (*Hades*), Heart Machine (*Hyper Light Drifter*), Extremely

OK Games (*Celeste*), Team Cherry (*Hollow Knight*), and Nicalis (*The Binding of Isaac*).

1.2.3 Top 5 Countries in the Indie Game Market

- The Asia-Pacific region led the market in 2024, holding a 45% share (China, South Korea, Japan).
- United States: the largest hub for releases and premium revenue.
- United Kingdom, Germany, and France: strong markets, supported by tax incentives and active PC gaming communities.
- Canada: notable for government support of studios and accelerators.
- Brazil: the largest market in Latin America, growing rapidly; generating over BRL 12 billion per year in games and attracting international investors (Google, Newzoo).

1.2.4 Brazil's Position

- Brazil accounts for roughly 1.5% of the global gaming market but leads Latin America in both the number of studios and growth rate.
- Local incentives and accelerator programs help studios overcome challenges related to access to capital and bureaucracy.
- The national environment, despite its progress, still presents barriers such as economic volatility, concentration in major cities, and challenges in exporting content.

1.2.5 Analysis of Supply, Demand, Risks, and Challenges

- Oversupply (“oversaturation”) is one of the biggest obstacles: thousands of releases each year make it difficult for new titles to be discovered and consumed.
- There is demand, and it is growing—particularly for authentic experiences, deep narratives, and innovative games—but reaching the audience requires strategy, marketing investment, and persistence.
- The main risks include:
 - High competition and difficulty gaining visibility.
 - Limited access to resources for production and marketing.
 - Underestimation of timelines, pipelines, and costs.

- Team burnout and challenges in sustaining the business.
- For narrative-driven games, the challenge is even greater, as these projects require more time and refinement, along with engaging storytelling and consistent gameplay.

1.2.6 Why Indie Games Fail

- Seventy percent of indie games do not reach the break-even point.
- Main reasons:
 - Poor execution in development and launch.
 - Lack of operational and financial planning.
 - Insufficient investment or attention to marketing and promotion.
 - Excessive noise; difficulty standing out in a saturated market.

1.2.7 How to Succeed in Indie Games

- Focus on differentiation: innovative mechanics, authentic storytelling, and an engaged community.
- Solid planning: treat the project as a business, invest in marketing, establish efficient pipelines, and pursue strategic partnerships.
- Success examples: *Undertale* (Toby Fox) — started solo with crowdfunding and gained massive success thanks to distinctive writing; *Celeste* (Extremely OK Games) — focus on accessibility and emotional storytelling; *Hades* (Supergiant) — innovative repetition of narrative and gameplay combined; *Hollow Knight* (Team Cherry) — commitment to polish and community building; *The Binding of Isaac* (Nicalis) — continuous evolution and strong niche appeal.

1.2.8 Conclusion of the Analyses

The indie market is becoming increasingly competitive, with even greater potential for innovation and growth. Studios that stand out are those that invest in both creativity and operational execution, including marketing. Brazil is rapidly advancing as a Latin American hub but still faces structural and capital-related challenges. Narrative indie games remain a significant opportunity for cultural impact, yet they require careful planning and resilience to succeed in an increasingly saturated market.

1.3 Business Model Definition

In our indie game startup, we have adopted the **B2C (Business to Consumer)** business model, in which we sell directly to the end consumer. We chose to market our games at a fixed price on **Steam**, one of the largest digital distribution platforms for PC games, ensuring efficient and scalable access to our target audience.

This strategic decision was based on crucial factors for the success of our company, such as simplicity in monetization, revenue predictability, and alignment with players' purchasing behavior. Unlike models that rely on microtransactions or subscriptions, direct sales allow us to offer a complete experience to the player from the moment of purchase, ensuring clear and immediate value for our product.

1.3.1 Reason for Choosing the Steam Platform

Steam is the main platform chosen for selling indie games for several reasons supported by recent data and market analysis:

1.3.1.1 Breadth and Quality of the Audience

The platform brings together millions of daily users who have an active interest in spending money to play, unlike stores focused on free-to-play or more casual games. This qualified audience is crucial for converting real sales.

1.3.1.2 Strong Representation of Indie Games

Around 96% of all games on Steam are indie, representing 40% of units sold and nearly 30% of the store's total revenue, demonstrating the strong penetration and relevance of the indie market on the platform.

1.3.1.3 Advanced Algorithm and Promotion Tools

Steam offers an algorithm that promotes quality games regardless of studio size, using tags and automated curation to properly position the game for its target audience.

1.3.1.4 Control and Autonomy for Developers

Developers have tools to publish and manage their games directly, adjusting prices, releasing updates and DLCs, and accessing detailed analytics to support strategic decisions.

1.3.1.5 Global Visibility and Reach

Steam is a worldwide showcase that enables instant distribution across multiple countries with multilingual support, facilitating audience expansion and international revenue generation.

1.3.1.6 Platform Quality and Trust

A publishing fee (currently around R\$ 380) creates a barrier that reduces low-quality submissions, increasing overall consumer confidence and the perceived value of available games.

1.3.1.7 Proven Success of Major Indie

Titles Games like Stardew Valley, Hollow Knight, Celeste, and Undertale achieved commercial success with the help of Steam, highlighting the platform's sales potential and community-building power.

1.3.1.8 Community and Social Support

Steam offers channels for reviews, forums, and integration with social networks and streaming, facilitating communication and player engagement—key elements for word-of-mouth marketing.

Together, these factors make Steam the best choice for indie developers who, once their game is completed, want to achieve visibility, sales traction, and sustainable success in the global gaming market.

1.4 Growth and Expansion Plan

The growth and expansion strategy of Flare Dynamic Art is centered on establishing a solid presence in the gaming industry through the successful launch of our first game. This initial release serves as a foundation for building brand recognition and attracting a loyal player base.

To support our expansion, we seek strategic investments that will provide the necessary resources for development, marketing, and operational growth. By securing funding through investors, partnerships, and industry grants, we aim to strengthen our capabilities and accelerate our market entry.

Additionally, our marketing strategy is designed to maximize visibility through major industry events, gaming conventions, and digital campaigns. By showcasing our game to key audiences, engaging with influencers, and leveraging media coverage, we plan to create strong momentum and drive sustained growth in the market.

1.4.1 Phase 1: Brand Consolidation and First Game Launch (0 - 2 years)

Establish a strong foundation in the indie market, launch our first game, and build an engaged community.

- **Pilot Project:** We will develop a story with a strong narrative impact to create an immersive and accessible atmosphere, with a strong philosophical and reflective appeal.
- **Focus on Innovation and Differentiation:** Unique gameplay mechanics that stimulate critical thinking.
- **Use of Accessible and Efficient Technologies:** Development using the Godot engine to optimize costs.

- **Lean and Agile Team:** Internal development by the co-founders across all game areas.
- **Crowdfunding:** Engage a fanbase from the start to validate the project and raise initial capital.
- **Incentive Grants and Partnerships:** Seek support from game programs, grant opportunities, and incubators.
- **Early Access Game Launch:** First on Steam.
- **Publication on Specialized Websites:** Feature on sites such as IGN Brazil, Kotaku, and Rock Paper Shotgun.
- **Participation in Indie Events:** Examples include BIG Festival, GDC, Gamescom, Brazil Game Show, and IndieCade.

2. Marketing and Commercial

Marketing and commercial strategies play a crucial role in a company's success by defining how it attracts, engages, and retains customers. In this chapter, we will explore key aspects that shape these strategies.

Visual identity and branding establish the company's image, including logos, colors, messaging, and positioning, to create a recognizable and memorable brand. The marketing plan outlines the company's promotional strategies, target audience, and communication channels to drive awareness and demand. Sales strategy and distribution channels focus on how products or services are sold, the pricing model, and the methods used to reach customers, whether through direct sales, partnerships, or e-commerce.

Budget allocation proposal ensures that marketing and sales efforts are financially sustainable by distributing resources efficiently across different initiatives. Finally, the customer service policy defines how the company interacts with customers, ensuring a positive experience and long-term loyalty. Together, these components create a structured approach to market positioning, revenue generation, and customer satisfaction.

2.1 Visual Identity and Branding

Flare Dynamic Art is an independent game studio with its name inspired by the optical effect caused by an intense bright contrasting with its surroundings, evoking the shine of a star. This phenomenon can be observed in signal flares or highlighted sun rays casting in the environment. Its visual identity, on other hand, has a retro style look inspired by a retro 70's design with its color palette, and fonts and shapes used to give a kind of retro 90's look to the design.

Its logo uses a minimalist concept to represent this luminous effect, resembling a simplified image of a star with intense light rays extending from a bright core. This representation symbolizes the spark of creativity, inventiveness, and passion that drives independent game development. It has four variations for different contexts, each one having colored, black and white examples.

Just as a flare illuminates and stands out in its surroundings, Flare Dynamic Art aims to break conventions, explore new ideas, and create unique experiences in its work. The intense glow reflected in its visual identity embodies the company's creative mindset, which values innovation, artistic freedom, and the pursuit of new and inventive ways to engage players.

2.1.1 Logo

The main logo is the name "FLARE" in front of the light flare minimalist symbol, used to represent the brand and the company in most situations.



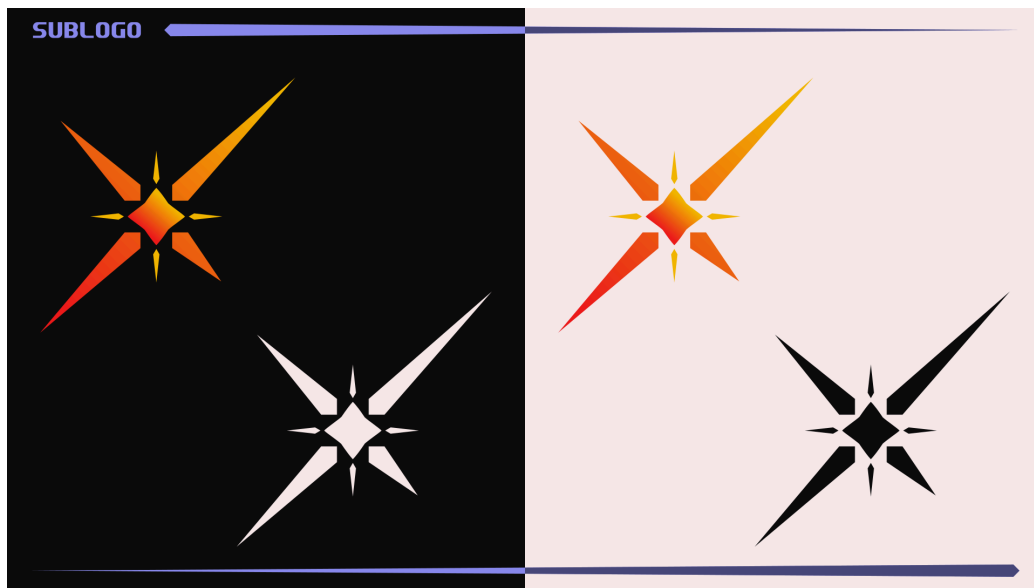
Source: Flare Dynamic Art (2025). original artwork.

The secondary logo consists of the name “FLARE” and the light flare minimalist symbol separated, the symbol appearing in front of the name. Mainly used in situations where the vertical space is limited and/or where the name “FLARE” should be in emphasis.



Source: Flare Dynamic Art (2025). original artwork.

In cases where it is not possible to use the main logo and/or the name “FLARE” is not needed, it is possible to use just the light flare minimalist symbol as a logo



Source: Flare Dynamic Art (2025). original artwork.

It is possible to also use the “FLARE” name as a logo alone, with its blocky and compact shape being easy to place around large amounts of text.



Source: Flare Dynamic Art (2025). original artwork.

2.1.2 Color Palette and Fonts

COLOR PALETTE

MAIN COLORS



R:74 G:74 B:122
C:39 M:39 Y:0 K:52



R:243 G:183 B:0
C:0 M:25 Y:100 K:5



R:255 G:98 B:1
C:0 M:62 Y:100 K:0

BACKGROUND COLORS



R:13 G:13 B:13
C:0 M:0 Y:0 K:95



R:242 G:242 B:242
C:0 M:0 Y:0 K:5

ACCENT COLORS



R:139 G:139 B:235
C:41 M:41 Y:0 K:8



R:246 G:62 B:2
C:0 M:75 Y:99 K:4



R:235 G:29 B:29
C:0 M:88 Y:88 K:8

TYPOGRAPHY

Cascadia Code

Main font

a b c d e f g
h i j k l m n
o p q r s t u
v w x y z

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

1234567890

QUANTIFIER NBP

SECONDARY FONT

a b c d e f g h i
j k l m n o p q r
s t u u w x y z

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

1234567890

Source: Flare Dynamic Art (2025). original artwork.

2.2 Marketing Plan

The initial marketing strategies are focused on content creation for social media, including Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, and Twitter, showcasing the ongoing development of the game and fostering an organic community over time.

The strategy is to post three times a week. According to the source [Sprout Social](#), the best days to post are Tuesday, Wednesday, and Thursday, between 9:00 AM and 3:00 PM.

The posting schedule will be as follows:

- **Tuesday:** Short video post on Instagram/TikTok/YouTube Shorts (the same video will be posted across all platforms)
- **Wednesday:** Post on YouTube (Devlog update video)
- **Thursday:** Post on Twitter/Instagram (Concept art or development clips)

In addition, we will create an open Discord community, allowing people interested in the project to interact with the team.

2.3 Sales strategy and distribution channels

2.3.1 Meta Ads (Facebook & Instagram)

- **Objective:** Increase engagement and drive traffic to the game page.
- **Suggested Budget:** R\$ 2,000 – R\$ 5,000

How to Use:

- Create ads with short gameplay videos, teasers, and eye-catching images.
- Target fans of similar games.

- Test different formats (Stories, Feed, Reels).
- Implement retargeting for users who visited the game page.

 [Facebook Ads Manager](#)

2.3.2 Google Ads & YouTube Ads

- **Objective:** Appear to players searching for similar games.
- **Suggested Budget: R\$ 3,000 – R\$ 6,000**

How to Use:

- Create video ads on YouTube (pre-roll before videos of similar games).
- Use Google Display Ads to reach gaming sites and blogs.
- Run search ads targeting game-related keywords.

 [Google Ads](#)

2.3.3 TikTok Ads

- **Objective:** Create hype and make the game go viral before launch.
- **Suggested Budget: R\$ 2,000 – R\$ 4,000**

How to Use:

- Create short ads (10-15 seconds) featuring fun moments from the game.
- Leverage trends and challenges to encourage UGC (User-Generated Content).
- Test partnerships with small/medium influencers.

 [TikTok Ads](#)

2.3.4 Game Discovery Platforms

- **Objective:** Expand the player base at launch.
- **Suggested Budget: R\$ 2,000 – R\$ 5,000**

Where to Advertise:

- **Reddit Ads** for gaming communities (e.g., r/indiegames).
- **Steam Ads** to increase wishlists and pre-sales.
- **Discord Ads** for promotions within gaming communities.

 [Steamworks Marketing](#)

2.4.0 Budget Allocation Proposal

With an initial budget proposal of R\$ 25,000, the resource distribution plan across various platforms aims to maximize engagement and drive game acquisitions. The allocation is represented in the table below:

Budget Allocation		
Platform	Investment (R\$)	Objective
Facebook & Instagram Ads	R\$ 6,000	Engagement, remarketing and traffic generation
Google & YouTube Ads	R\$ 7,000	Target highly interested players searching for similar games

Budget Allocation		
TikTok Ads	R\$ 4,500	Create hype and viral exposure pre-launch
Influencers (small/medium)	R\$ 5,000	Gameplay videos, first impressions and review content
Steam Ads	R\$ 2,500	Boost wishlist, conversions and launch visibility

Total: R\$ 25,000

2.4.1 Simplified Marketing Plan — R\$ 25,000 (12 Months)

Build a loyal and engaged community that follows the game's development, drives Steam wishlists, and supports sales at launch — using a lean, cost-efficient strategy suitable for solo development.

Investment Plan (12 Months – R\$ 25,000)				
Stage	Duration	%	Amount (R\$)	Focus

Investment Plan (12 Months – R\$ 25,000)				
Phase 1 – Awareness / Discovery	Months 1–4	35 %	8,750	Build initial visibility on TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube.
Phase 2 – Engagement / Community	Months 5–9	40 %	10,000	Strengthen community on Discord and Steam; consistent content output.
Phase 3 – Pre-Launch Hype	Months 10–12	25 %	6,250	Ads, official trailer release, and small influencer wave.

Total: R\$ 25,000

Focused on ROI and organic momentum.

Channel Distribution (R\$ 25,000)			
Channel	%	Amount (R\$)	Purpose
TikTok + Reels (Ads + Organic)	35%	8,750	Best CPM, fast awareness, potential for virality.

Channel Distribution (R\$ 25,000)			
YouTube (Devlogs + Ads)	25%	6,250	Trailers, narrative building, development updates.
Instagram / Meta Ads	20%	5,000	Visual connection and Steam/Discord redirection.
Influencers (Micro Only)	12%	3,000	Gameplay reactions, first impressions, niche promotion.
Tools & Content Production	8%	2,000	Editing tools, thumbnails, sound design add-ons.

2.4.2 Summary Timeline (12 Months)

Months 1–4: Awareness

- Launch YouTube, TikTok, Threads
 - Release Devlog #1
 - Art showcases and early gameplay clips
- Goal:** 1,500 followers / 200 Discord members

Months 5–9: Engagement

- Weekly content

- Reels/TikTok with more gameplay

- Small teasers

Goal: 7,000 followers / 1,000 Discord members / 3,000 wishlists

Months 10–12: Pre-Launch Hype

- Official trailer

- Light paid ads

- 1–3 micro-influencer videos

Goal: 12,000 followers / 5,000 wishlists

Expected Return (Lean Scenario)

- **Estimated reach:** 2–4 million impressions

- **Cross-platform followers:** 8,000–12,000

- **Discord members:** 1,000–1,500

- **Steam wishlists:** 5,000–7,000

- **Estimated cost per wishlist:** R\$ 3–6

Content Structure (Optimized for Low Budget)		
Content Type	Platform	Purpose
Short devlogs	YouTube	Story, transparency, development updates
Short clips	TikTok/Reels	Engagement and virality
Art and behind-the-scenes	Instagram	Visual identity and worldbuilding
Polls and sneak peeks	Discord	Retention and community bonding

Monthly Roadmap (Lean Budget)		
Month	Theme	Accumulated Goal
1	World introduction and Devlog #1	500–800 followers

Monthly Roadmap (Lean Budget)		
2	Art, pixel art, and soundtrack	1,200 followers
3	Early gameplay reveal	2,000 followers
4	First boss showcase	3,000 followers
5	Mini-Teaser #1	4,000 followers
6	Lore drops and behind-the-scenes	5,000 followers
7	Abilities showcase	6,000 followers
8	Alpha reveal (not public yet)	7,000 followers
9	15-second trailer	8,000 followers
10	Official Trailer	9,500 followers
11	Micro-influencers (1–3 videos)	10,500 followers

Monthly Roadmap (Lean Budget)		
12	Pre-demo campaign	12,000 followers / 5,000–7,000 wishlists

Posting Strategy (Lean Method)

TikTok / Reels — 3–4 times per week

Gameplay clips, humorous comparisons, and creative short videos.

YouTube — 1 devlog per month

Five to eight minutes, focusing on worldbuilding, progress, and design decisions.

Instagram — 2–3 posts per week

Art, screenshots, and lore-focused carousels.

Discord — Weekly activity

Sneak peeks, polls, and development updates.

Lean Investment Schedule (R\$ 25,000)		
Month	Amount (R\$)	Focus

Lean Investment Schedule (R\$ 25,000)		
1	2,000	Branding and initial awareness
2	1,500	TikTok and Reels ads
3	2,000	YouTube teaser ad
4	1,500	General reach
5	2,000	TikTok retargeting
6	1,500	Instagram and YouTube
7	2,000	Alpha campaign
8	2,500	TikTok and remarketing
9	3,000	Short trailer push
10	3,000	Official trailer ads

Lean Investment Schedule (R\$ 25,000)		
11	3,000	Micro-influencers
12	3,000	Pre-launch and pre-demo campaign

Total: R\$ 25,000

With a lean and realistic budget of R\$ 25,000, this 12-month plan maximizes organic reach and applies targeted paid promotion when it offers the highest return.

The strategy emphasizes:

- Strong visual identity
- Continuous community-focused content
- Growth through TikTok and YouTube
- Converting followers into Steam wishlists

This approach supports a realistic indie development outcome of **5,000–7,000**

Steam wishlists before launch, establishing the foundation for a successful release.

2.5 Customer Service Policy

Our Customer Service Policy is structured to provide players with a seamless and professional support experience while fostering a positive gaming environment. Given the highly interactive nature of the gaming industry, we recognize the importance of prompt responses, clear communication, and continuous engagement with our player base.

To ensure efficient player support, we will actively monitor our social media channels, gaming forums, and community platforms where discussions about our

game take place. Our team will be responsible for promptly addressing player inquiries, clarifying doubts, and providing solutions to common issues. Additionally, we will actively gather and analyze player feedback to identify potential improvements and refine the overall gaming experience.

For issue resolution, we will establish a ticketing system to categorize and track player concerns systematically. A Knowledge Base and FAQ section will also be available to allow users to find quick solutions independently, reducing response times and optimizing support efficiency.

Regarding Refunds and Exchange Policies, we will follow industry-standard practices while maintaining a fair and transparent approach. Refunds will be evaluated on a case-by-case basis, considering factors such as technical issues, accidental purchases, or regulatory compliance. In the case of in-game purchases, our policy will clearly define eligibility criteria, timeframes for refund requests, and potential exchange options for digital content. This ensures that players receive a reasonable resolution while maintaining the integrity of our monetization strategy.

To promote a safe and respectful gaming environment, we will enforce a Code of Conduct to regulate player interactions. This includes measures against toxic behavior, harassment, cheating, and other disruptive actions within our gaming ecosystem. A reporting system will allow players to flag inappropriate behavior, and disciplinary actions will be applied accordingly to maintain a fair and enjoyable experience for all users.

By integrating these policies and strategies, we aim to build a strong relationship with our player community, ensuring that they feel valued, heard, and supported throughout their gaming experience. As our company and player base grow, we will continuously refine and expand our customer service approach to uphold high engagement and satisfaction standards.

3. Organizational Structure

Organizational structure defines how a company's workforce is arranged, the distribution of responsibilities, and how teams collaborate to achieve business goals. In this chapter, we will discuss key concepts that shape the organizational structure.

The development sphere focuses on the growth and evolution of the organization, encompassing strategies for talent development, leadership, and skill-building. The business sphere refers to the various functional areas of the business, such as marketing, sales, operations, and finance, and how they are structured to support organizational goals. Required tools and systems cover the technology and processes needed to enable efficient operations and communication, ensuring smooth workflows and data management.

Infrastructure refers to the physical and digital assets (e.g., office space, IT systems) required for the business to function effectively. Finally, the physical or virtual location examines the impact of the company's location—whether in a physical office or virtual space—on operations, collaboration, and overall business performance. Together, these components form a cohesive framework that ensures the business operates efficiently and is positioned for growth and success.

3.1 Development Sphere

The team responsible for product development focuses on building the game, ensuring quality, innovation, and an immersive experience for players.

- Development Leader – Coordinates the technical team and defines the game's guidelines.
- Developer 1 – Responsible for game mechanics design and gameplay implementation.
- Developer 2 – Works on programming, optimization, and feature implementation.

Resource Organization:

All technical documentation, development workflows, and progress reports are maintained in Google Docs and Google Sheets, facilitating real-time access and updates. Source code versions and files are stored in Google Drive in an organized way to ensure easy access and sharing among team members.

3.2 Business Sphere

The business and strategy team is responsible for structuring the company, securing investments, marketing, and documentation.

- Business and Strategy Leader – Oversees company operations and defines strategic planning.
- Strategist 1 – Focuses on documentation, legal structure, and business partnerships.
- Strategist 2 – Works on marketing strategies, promotion, and market relationships.

Resource Organization:

All strategic planning records, contracts, financial reports, and marketing documentation are kept organized in Google Docs and Google Sheets. This approach makes collaboration among team members easy and ensures that information is always up-to-date and accessible for quick and informed decision-making.

3.3 Required Tools and Systems

At this stage, the company does not require enterprise management software, as operations will be managed solely by the four founding partners. The necessary tools and systems will be minimal and primarily focused on supporting the core development process. Each partner will be responsible for specific areas to ensure efficiency and alignment in execution:

- **Game Design Tools:** Software for designing game mechanics, rules, and progression.
- **Development and Programming Tools:** Integrated Development Environments (IDEs), version control systems, and game engines for coding, AI implementation, physics, and rendering.
- **Art and Graphic Design Software:** Tools for character creation, environment design, animation, and 3D modeling.
- **Audio Production Software:** Platforms for composing soundtracks, designing sound effects, and recording voice overs.
- **Project Management and Collaboration Platforms:** Tools for scheduling, task tracking, and documentation to coordinate development efforts.
- **Quality Assurance and Testing Tools:** Software for debugging, performance analysis, and playtesting to ensure a polished experience.
- **Narrative Development Tools:** Platforms for writing and structuring dialogues, storylines, and worldbuilding elements.
- **Monetization and Market Analysis Tools:** Software for tracking industry trends, managing pricing strategies, and documenting financial planning.
- **Marketing and Community Engagement Platforms:** Tools for social media management, promotional content creation, and player feedback analysis.
- **UX/UI Design Tools:** Software for designing and testing user interfaces and improving accessibility.
- **Documentation and Process Management Systems:** Platforms for maintaining and reviewing game design documents (GDD) to development.

With this structure, the team will ensure that all essential development needs are met, optimizing workflows without the immediate necessity of enterprise-scale management systems.

3.4 Infrastructure and Physical or Virtual Location

At this stage, our company will operate fully remotely, with no physical studio or headquarters. All game development processes, meetings, and strategic discussions among the partners will be conducted virtually. This approach allows us to optimize resources, reduce operational costs, and maintain flexibility, enabling each team member to work from their preferred location while ensuring seamless collaboration.

To facilitate efficient communication and workflow, we will leverage digital tools and platforms suited for remote game development. Project management will be structured using task-tracking systems, cloud-based repositories, and real-time communication channels to ensure that all aspects of the development cycle remain well-coordinated.

Virtual meetings will be held on a regular basis, ensuring alignment on project milestones, design decisions, and overall business strategy. By embracing a remote-first structure, we can focus on game production while maintaining a streamlined and adaptable operational model. As the company grows, we will evaluate the need for a dedicated physical space based on business demands and team expansion.

4. Financial Organization

Managing the financials for indie game development is crucial to ensure the project is successful within the established budget. Here's a breakdown of costs for each area, necessary equipment, and software costs to provide a clear financial overview for our indie game startup.

4.1 Initial Capital and Sources of Funding

As an indie game development company, incorporated as a limited liability company (LTDA) with four partners, we decided to start our project by utilizing our

own capital and the equipment we already own. This approach allows us to have greater control over the development process and the creative direction of our games. However, we are aware that in order to expand our operations and take our project to the next level, we need to explore different sources of funding.

Currently, we are exploring various funding options, including:

- **Angel Investors:** We are seeking investors who believe in our vision and can provide the necessary capital to drive our development forward.
- **Crowdfunding:** We are considering crowdfunding platforms, where we can present our game to the public and raise funds directly from fans, offering exclusive rewards in return.
- **Grants and Funding Programs:** We are actively researching grants and support programs for game projects, which may offer financial resources without the need for repayment.
- **Donations:** We are exploring the possibility of building a community around our project, where fans and supporters can contribute financially in exchange for early access to the game and other perks.

These funding sources will help ensure that we can bring our vision to life and create memorable gaming experiences for our future players. We are excited about the possibilities ahead and committed to pursuing the best options for our project.

4.2 Operational Cost Plan and Pricing Strategy

Based on the initial project budget analysis, we included all essential professionals required for development. Salary estimates were based on average values for each role, according to data from the Glassdoor website.

4.2.1 Development and Operations Team

Our team consists of four developers and a project manager, each responsible for different aspects of game development.

Creating an indie game involves various areas of knowledge. Some of the main ones are:

Assigned Roles - Operations				
Position	Main Responsibilities	Monthly Salary Average	Source	Estimated Hourly Wage
Game Developer	Programming languages, game engines (Godot), data structures, and algorithms	\$3,000.00	Glassdoor	\$13.64
Game Designer	Game rules and mechanics, level design, balance, and difficulty progression	\$5,000.00	Glassdoor	\$22.73
2D/3D Artist	Pixel art, 2D or 3D modeling, texturing and shaders, character and object animation	\$3,500.00	Glassdoor (Artista 3D) , Glassdoor (Artista 2D)	\$15.91
Sound Designer	Creating sound effects, atmospheres, sonic textures, and environments for the imagined world	\$7,316.58	Ebac Online e Educa Mais Brasil	\$33.26

Assigned Roles - Operations				
Position	Main Responsibilities	Monthly Salary Average	Source	Estimated Hourly Wage
Game Developer	Programming languages, game engines (Godot), data structures, and algorithms	\$3,000.00	Glassdoor	\$13.64
Game Writer	Storyline and characters, game worldbuilding	\$3,000.00	Glassdoor	\$13.64
Project Manager	Workflow organization, deadlines, and agile methodologies (Scrum, Kanban)	\$13,000.00	Glassdoor	\$59.09
Game Marketing	Launch strategies, promotion, social media, and community engagement	\$3,850.00	Glassdoor	\$17.50

4.2.2 Initial Production Cost

The startup's initial production cost is concentrated on the development equipment of each team member. Below are the detailed costs:

Equipment Cost Table			
Item	Quantity	Unit Price	Total Price
¹Notebook Latitude 5420	2	R\$ 2,399.00	R\$ 4,798.00
Notebook Gamer SuperFrame	1	R\$ 6,999.90	R\$ 6,999.90
*Desktop	1	R\$ 7,775.10	R\$ 7,775.10

Desktop Parts and Prices Table			
Component	Selected	Price	Link
Processor	Intel Core i5-10600K 4.1 GHz 6-Core	R\$ 1,314.43 at Amazon	Link
Motherboard	MSI MAG B460M MORTAR Micro ATX LGA 1200	R\$ 828.43 at Terabyte	Link
Memory	Kingston HyperX Fury RGB (RGB) 16 GB (2x8 GB) DDR4-3733	R\$ 259.98 at Mercado Livre	Link
Storage	Western Digital SSD WD Green 1 TB 2.5"	R\$ 349.99 at Amazon	Link
Storage	Corsair SSD MP510 240 GB M.2-2280	R\$ 549.99 at Pichau	Link
Graphics Card	Asus GeForce RTX 2070 Super 8 GB OC	R\$ 2,719.20 at Terabyte	Link

Desktop Parts and Prices Table			
Component	Selected	Price	Link
Monitor	LG 29WK600 29.0" 2560 x 1080 75 Hz	R\$ 1,439.00 at Mercado Livre	Link
Mouse	Redragon Lonewolf 2 Pro Wired	R\$ 136.99 at Kabum	Link
Keyboard	T-Dagger Bora	R\$ 152.92 at Terabyte	Link
Total		R\$ 7.775,10	

²Generated by MEUPC.NET on 02/25/2025 at 09:00

Observations

- The total value is calculated by multiplying the quantity by the unit price.
- The table does not include taxes or other fees.

¹ The Notebook Latitude 5420 Global was discontinued by Dell as of the research date (found in references. Model released in 2022). The price was based on the average found on the Mercado Livre website for refurbished models, without considering modifications made for the Inteli version, such as the additional cost of the touch screen and processor. Therefore, the cited price is a reference, also based on the machine's depreciation time.

² Estimated price according to build and component searches conducted on the MeuPc - Build website. Evaluating the values of both tables, we can conclude that:

Total Initial Machine Production Cost: **R\$ 18,902.91**

4.3 Software Cost

Software used for development

- **Godot Engine:** Free
- **Blender:** Free

4.3.1 Publishing Costs

4.3.1.1 Steam

- Publishing Cost: \$100 (refunded after reaching \$1,000 in sales).
- Sales Commission:
- 30% for games with net sales below \$10 million.
- 25% for games with sales between \$10 million and \$50 million.
- 20% for games exceeding \$50 million in sales.

4.3.1.2 Epic Games

- Initial Cost: Free (no publishing fee).
- Revenue Share: 88% for the developer, 12% for Epic.
- Unreal Engine Royalties: Normally 5%, but waived for sales through Epic Games Store.
- As of 2025, reduced to 3.5% if launched on Epic first or simultaneously with other stores.

4.4 Budget Allocation Proposal

With an initial budget proposal of R\$ 15,000, the resource distribution plan across various platforms aims to maximize engagement and drive game acquisitions. The allocation is represented in the table below:

Budget Allocation		
Platform	Investment (R\$)	Objective
Facebook & Instagram Ads	R\$ 3,500	Engagement and initial traffic

Budget Allocation		
Google & YouTube Ads	R\$ 4,500	Target players searching for similar games
TikTok Ads	R\$ 3,000	Create hype and viral momentum before launch
Influencers (small/medium)	R\$ 2,500	Gameplay videos and first impressions
Steam Ads	R\$ 1,500	Increase wishlist and conversions

4.5 Development Cost and Expenses

The table below provides an estimated cost breakdown for a one-year development cycle, divided into two-week sprints. Each sprint includes 56 work hours per person, considering a workload of 4 hours per day over 7 working days per week.

This cost represents the development efforts for the first year, which required the involvement of multiple areas due to the creation of an MVP to be completed by the end of the year. Therefore, these values do not necessarily reflect the costs for subsequent years, as future development phases may demand fewer resources or a different team structure.

The hourly wage for each role is based on the "Assigned Roles – Operations" table, reflecting the corresponding average monthly salary. The total cost was calculated by multiplying the Hourly Rate by the Number of Hours per Sprint, considering the number of people in each role and the total number of planned sprints throughout the year.

- Sprint Duration: 2 weeks (7 days each)
- Hours per Sprint: 4 hours per day × 7 days = 28 hours per week = 56 hours per sprint
- Cost per Sprint: Hourly rate × Hours per sprint

Cost - First Year							
Role	Hourly Rate	Hours per Sprint	Cost per Sprint	People	Total Cost per Sprint	Sprints	Total Cost
Developer	R\$13.64	56	R\$763.84	4	R\$3,055.36	16	R\$48,885.76
Game Designer	R\$22.73	56	R\$1,273.04	3	R\$3,819.12	5	R\$19,095.60
2D/3D Artist	R\$15.91	56	R\$891.04	2	R\$1,782.08	5	R\$8,910.40
Sound Designer	R\$33.26	56	R\$1,864.56	1	R\$1,864.56	2	R\$3,729.12
Game Writer	R\$13.64	56	R\$763.84	2	R\$1,527.68	2	R\$3,055.36
Project Manager	R\$59.09	56	R\$3,309.04	1	R\$3,309.04	20	R\$66,180.80
Game Marketing	R\$17.50	56	R\$980.00	4	R\$3,920.00	5	R\$19,600.00
Total							R\$169,457.04

Estimated Development Cost First Year: \$169,457.04

4.5.1 Investment Calculation in the Project

1. Development Cost

Estimated value: R\$ 169,457.04

The game development includes expenses with the programming team, design, art, soundtrack, and testing.

2. Marketing Investment

The marketing efforts in the first year were primarily organic, with no significant direct financial investment allocated to paid campaigns. The estimated value reflects the potential cost of activities such as advertising, social media promotion, influencer partnerships, and other outreach strategies, but these were not executed with dedicated funding during the MVP phase.

3. Publishing Cost

Publishing the game on the Steam and Epic Games Store platforms involves fees and commissions on sales. Below are the details of the costs for each platform:

4. Steam

Publishing fee: \$100 per game (approximately R\$ 500, considering an exchange rate of R\$ 5.00/USD).

Commission: 30% of sales (reduced to 25% after \$10 million and 20% after \$50 million).

Epic Games Store

Publishing fee: Free

Commission: 12% of sales (the developer keeps 88%).

Cost Value

- **Development:** R\$169,457.04
- **Marketing:** Organic
- **Publishing (Steam + Epic):** R\$169,957.04

Total Estimated Cust: R\$ 169,957.04

4.5.2 Operational Expenses

The operational expenses represent the fixed and variable costs required to keep the studio running throughout the development of the project.

They include administrative expenses, infrastructure, essential services, and strategic marketing.

It is important to note that this is a **preliminary and simulated estimate**, based on the assumption that part of the gross revenue will be allocated to operational expenses — therefore, the values are **approximate**.

Below are the **average annual estimates** based on a small independent studio.

4.5.2.1 Operational Expenses (1 Year)

Category	Description	Monthly Cost (R\$)	Annual Cost (R\$)	Notes
Infrastructure				
Rent (office/studio)	Physical workspace for the team	3,000.00	36,000.00	Average value for a small office
Internet and telephone	Business plan	300.00	3,600.00	Stable internet for uploads and meetings
Electricity	Equipment and PCs	600.00	7,200.00	Average for 4 to 6 workstations
Equipment and maintenance	PCs, peripherals, upgrades	—	5,000.00	One-time annual cost
Administration and Support				
Accounting	Accounting office	500.00	6,000.00	Fiscal management and <i>Simples Nacional</i>

Legal	Consultations, contracts, and trademark registration	—	8,000.00	Average for occasional annual support
Licenses and software	Tools (Unity, Adobe, etc.)	600.00	7,200.00	Essential monthly licenses
Cloud services / hosting	Backup, repositories, website	250.00	3,000.00	AWS, Google Cloud, or GitHub
Human Resources and Operations				
Benefits and meals	Basic team support	800.00	9,600.00	Average estimate
Events (Networking)	Courses, game jams, BGS, GDC	—	4,000.00	Education and networking
Marketing and Communication				
Marketing (annual, concentrated)	Advertising, paid traffic, branding	—	70,000.00	Reserved for the final year
Taxes and fees	<i>Simples Nacional</i> , ISS, banking fees	—	8,000.00	Estimate proportional to revenue

4.5.2.2 Totals and Averages

Type	Amount (R\$)
------	--------------

Average monthly cost (without marketing)	6,550.00
Annual cost (without marketing)	78,600.00
Total annual cost (including marketing)	148,600.00

4.5.2.3. Four-Year Projection

Item	Estimate (R\$)	Notes
Total operational expenses (without marketing)	314,400.00	78,600 × 4 years
Marketing (concentrated in final year)	70,000.00	One-time cost for final promotion
Total (4 years)	384,400.00	Consolidated estimate for the full cycle

4.5.2.4 Considerations

The operational expenses form the foundation of the studio's sustainability, ensuring infrastructure, support, and stability throughout the entire development period.

The four-year projection accounts for **gradual growth, maintenance of physical structure, and a strategic increase in tools and marketing** during the final stage of the project.

4.7 Cash Flow Management

Cash flow control is essential for tracking financial health and ensuring there is enough money for operations and growth.

Revenue Sources

- **Game sales:** Revenue from platforms like Steam, Epic Games, and Itch.io.
- **Investments:** Funding from investors, financing, and crowdfunding.
- **Sponsorships & Partnerships:** Financial support from companies in exchange for promotion or collaboration.

Major Expenses

- Salaries and benefits
- Licenses and tools
- Marketing and promotions
- Infrastructure (equipment and internet)
- Distribution fees (Steam 30%, Epic Games 12%)

Financial Monitoring & Strategy

- Financial management will be handled collectively due to the small team.
- Use of financial tracking tools such as Excel, backed by invoices and records.
- Monthly financial updates and periodic strategy reviews.

4.8 Tax Regime Definition

For our startup, we will initially opt for the **Simples Nacional** tax regime. This choice is aligned with the company's early-stage structure and offers reduced tax complexity, simplified accounting, and a favorable tax burden for small businesses.

In our operational scenario, the company is classified as a **Microempresa (ME)**, as the activity of **game development** falls under the broader category of **software development and technology services**, which is fully eligible for the Simples Nacional regime.

This choice complies with the following legislation: Complementary Law No. 123/2006 (Simples Nacional Law), CGSN Resolution No. 140/2018, the National Tax Code (Law No. 5,172/1966), Social Security Legislation (Laws No. 8,212/1991 and 8,213/1991), Payroll Tax Exemption (Law No. 12,546/2011), and Decree-Law No. 1,598/1977 on the calculation of Actual and Presumed Profit.

4.8.1 Reason for Choosing Simples Nacional

Reduced and Unified Tax Burden – The Simples Nacional consolidates multiple federal, state, and municipal taxes into a single payment guide (DAS), reducing bureaucracy and simplifying operational management.

Progressive Rates – Taxes are calculated based on gross annual revenue, starting at 6% for companies earning up to R\$ 180,000 per year. This model is particularly advantageous for early-stage startups with controlled revenue.

Ease in Accounting – By simplifying ancillary obligations, Simples Nacional allows the company to focus its efforts on product development and strategic growth.

Reduction in Operational Costs – Companies under this regime benefit from reduced payroll charges, encouraging formal hiring and lowering labor costs.

Favorable Conditions for the Technology Sector – Software and game development activities fit into **Annex III or Annex V** of the Simples Nacional, depending on revenue and the “*fator r*” (payroll-to-revenue ratio). This may provide more attractive tax rates when compared to regimes such as Presumed Profit.

Investor Scenario – Estimated Effective Rate – For financial planning and investor transparency, we consider an **average effective tax rate of approximately 15.5%**, already incorporated into the product’s sale price. This estimate reflects our expected revenue progression and the application of the Simples Nacional brackets relevant to our activity.

4.8.2 Brief Explanation of How Simples Nacional Works

- Companies with annual gross revenue of up to **R\$ 4.8 million** may qualify for the regime.

- Taxes are paid through a single guide called **DAS (Documento de Arrecadação do Simples Nacional)**.
- The taxes covered include: IRPJ, CSLL, PIS, COFINS, ISS, ICMS, IPI, CPP, and INSS Patronal.
- The tax rate varies according to the progressive Simples Nacional table, based on gross accumulated revenue over the previous 12 months.

This initial choice allows our startup to scale in a structured and sustainable way. As the company grows in terms of revenue and operational complexity, we will evaluate migration to other tax regimes—such as **Lucro Presumido** or **Lucro Real**—should they become more advantageous in future expansion stages.

4.9 Monetization and Development Plan

Our monetization strategy is designed to support the development cycle in stages, generating early engagement, validating the product with the community, and creating diversified revenue streams both before and after the official game launch.

4.9.1 Development and Early Access (Crowdfunding Phase)

The game will be fully developed following the planned production roadmap. However, an early DEMO version will be made exclusively available to supporters of our crowdfunding campaign.

This early access model not only rewards contributors but also helps gather valuable feedback that can be incorporated into the final version, improving gameplay quality and community engagement.

4.9.2 Pre-Launch Monetization Through Merchandise

To generate initial revenue during the pre-launch phase and reinforce brand identity, we will introduce a line of **thematic merchandise**, including:

- T-shirts
- Notebooks
- Pens
- Collectible items
- Other branded accessories

These products serve two purposes:

- **Early revenue generation**, supporting ongoing development costs
- **Marketing impact**, promoting the brand and increasing anticipation for the DEMO release on platforms such as Steam

4.9.3 Public DEMO Release (Steam)

After the initial period reserved for crowdfunding supporters, the DEMO will be made available to the general public on Steam. This strategic release will:

- Build a broader player base
- Increase wishlists, improving platform visibility

- Prepare the market for the full game launch

4.9.4 Full Launch Monetization

Once development is complete, the game will be released commercially. Revenue will be generated from:

- **Direct game sales** on Steam and other digital distribution platforms
- Potential **DLCs**, expansions, or cosmetic add-ons depending on the long-term strategy
- Ongoing merchandise sales to maintain brand engagement

4.9.5 Long-Term Revenue Sustainability.

The combination of early monetization (crowdfunding + merchandise), public engagement (Steam DEMO), and the final product launch ensures a diversified revenue structure that supports both development and future updates.

5. Legal and Structural Foundation

The Legal and Structural Foundation of a company defines its formal establishment and compliance with legal requirements. This chapter covers essential aspects that ensure the business operates within the law. The legal nature determines the company's structure, such as sole proprietorship, partnership, or corporation, influencing liability, taxation, and governance. Company registration is the process of officially recognizing the business with the appropriate authorities, granting it legal status. The social contract outlines the company's internal agreements, ownership structure, and operational rules, ensuring clarity among stakeholders. Regulations and licenses encompass the legal requirements and industry-specific permits needed to operate, ensuring compliance with local, national,

and international standards. Together, these elements establish a solid foundation for the company's legitimacy, governance, and long-term sustainability.

5.1 Legal Nature

In the process of structuring the startup Flare Dynamic Art, defining its legal nature is a fundamental step, as it establishes the company's legal configuration in accordance with current legislation. This section was developed in accordance with:

- The Brazilian Civil Code (Law No. 10,406, January 10, 2002)
- The Corporations Law (Law No. 6,404, December 15, 1976)
- The Simples Nacional Law (Complementary Law No. 123, December 14, 2006)
- The Normative Instruction of the Federal Revenue of Brazil (RFB No. 1.634/2016)
- Complementary Law No. 182/2021 (Startup Legal Framework)

Considering the number of individuals (we are four) willing to build the startup, their financial realities, and the available investment scenario, it was decided, by mutual agreement, that the legal nature of the company will be a Limited Liability Company (LTDA). This choice is deemed the most suitable for the company's initial phase, considering the following factors:

5.1.1 Permission for Multiple Members

- The LTDA allows for a clear definition of the ownership interest of one or more partners through the articles of incorporation;
- It is possible to establish profit-sharing percentages based on each partner's contribution.

5.1.2 Protection of Personal Assets

- Unlike the Individual Entrepreneur (EI), the LTDA separates the personal assets of the partners from the company's assets;
- In the case of business debts, the personal assets of the partners are not at risk, except in cases of fraud or disregard of the legal personality.

5.1.3 Ease of attracting investments

- The LTDA allows the entry of investors through investment contracts without reversibility or convertible loan agreements, enabling the conversion of the investment into future equity participation;
- There is also the possibility of transitioning to a Corporation (S/A) if the company's growth requires such a change.

5.1.4 Tax Flexibility

- The company can choose from different tax regimes, including Simples Nacional, Presumed Profit, or Actual Profit.
- For the initial phase, the Simples Nacional is the most advantageous option, as it unifies taxes and reduces fiscal bureaucracy.

5.1.5 Less Bureaucracy Compared to a Corporation (S/A)

- The formation of a Corporation (S/A) would be excessively costly and complex for a startup in its early stage.
- The LTDA (Limited Liability Company) requires less bureaucracy for administration and accounting, providing greater agility in business management.

Given these advantages, structuring Flare Dynamic Art as a Limited Liability Company (LTDA) ensures greater legal security, flexibility in management, and better conditions for the company's sustainable growth.

5.2 Company Registration

The company registration is an essential step to ensure the legality and effectiveness of Flare Dynamic Art's operations in the market. The registration process will follow the current laws in Brazil, including:

- The Brazilian Civil Code (Law No. 10,406, of January 10, 2002)
- The Public Records Law (Law No. 6,015, of December 31, 1973)
- The ICMS Law (Complementary Law No. 87, of September 13, 1996)
- The ISS Law (Complementary Law No. 116, of July 31, 2003)

- The Federal Revenue Service Normative Instruction (RFB No. 1,634, of May 26, 2016)

The main procedures include:

- **National Register of Legal Entities (CNPJ):** registration with the Federal Revenue Service for tax and commercial purposes.
- **State Registration:** Mandatory for the collection of ICMS in the state of São Paulo.
- **Municipal Registration:** Necessary for the collection of ISS in the municipality of São Paulo (if applicable).
- **Business License:** issued by the São Paulo City Hall, essential for the commencement of activities.
- **Personal Documentation of the Partners:** includes ID, CPF, and proof of residence.

The completion of this process ensures that all activities are carried out within the legal framework, guaranteeing the stability and credibility of the company.

5.3 Social Contract

The Social Contract is the document that formalizes the constitution of the company and establishes the rules for the functioning of the partnership. This section is developed in accordance with the following legal standards:

- Brazilian Civil Code (Law No. 10.406/2002)
- Economic Freedom Law (Law No. 13.874/2019)
- Complementary Law No. 123/2006
- Arbitration Law (Law No. 9.307/1996)

The main elements that will compose the Social Contract of Flare Dynamic Art include:

- **Identification of the Partners:** names, CPF, RG, and addresses of the four partners.
- **Business Purpose:** definition of the activities carried out by the company.
- **Social Capital:** the invested amount and its distribution among the partners.
- **Rules of Administration:** rights and duties of the administrators.
- **Corporate Resolutions:** criteria for decision-making.
- **Entry and Exit of Partners:** conditions for changes in the partnership structure.
- **Profit Distribution:** criteria for profit sharing.
- **Conflict Resolution:** provision for mediation or arbitration.
- **Term and Signatures:** validity period of the contract and the signatures of the partners.

The formalization of the **Social Contract** ensures transparency and legal security, establishing solid foundations for the operation and growth of the company.

5.4 Regulations and Licenses

Below are the key laws that address regulations and licenses, although some address the topic partially. These norms are essential to ensure that our startup is legally compliant, enabling a successful and legal operation:

- **Law No. 8.401/1992**
- **Law No. 10.454/2002**
- **Ordinance No. 502/2021 of the Ministry of Justice and Public Security**
- **Child and Adolescent Statute (ECA) – Law No. 8.069/1990**
- **Software Law (Law No. 9.609/1998)**
- **Copyright Law (Law No. 9.610/1998)**
- **Industrial Property Law (Law No. 9.279/1996)**
- **General Data Protection Law (LGPD – Law No. 13.709/2018)**
- **Consumer Protection Code (Law No. 8.078/1990)**
- **Internet Civil Framework (Law No. 12.965/2014)**

- **Decree No. 7.962/2013**
- **E-commerce Law (Law No. 12.965/2014 - Internet Civil Framework)**

5.4.1 Registration with Ancine (National Cinema Agency)

If our startup develops products containing audiovisual elements, it may be necessary to register them with Ancine. This is particularly relevant if our products feature narratives, animations, or other components classified as audiovisual works. The registration ensures compliance with legal requirements related to content production, avoiding regulatory issues.

5.4.2 Indicative Rating

The age classification is mandatory for games that will be marketed. We must request the classification from the Secretariat of Justice and Citizenship of the State of São Paulo or the Ministry of Justice. This regulation aims to inform users about the content of the games, ensuring that the appropriate audience has access to the material, in accordance with the current legislation.

5.4.3 Use of Software License

If we use third-party tools to develop our products, it is essential to ensure that we have the appropriate licenses. This includes software, graphic libraries, and any other resources that may have usage restrictions. Failure to comply with these requirements could result in legal penalties and marketing restrictions.

5.4.4 Intellectual Property Regulations

We must be attentive to intellectual property regulations to protect our copyrights, trademarks, and patents. Registering our trademark with the INPI (National Institute of Industrial Property) is essential to ensure that our visual identity and name are protected against misuse by third parties, preventing future legal disputes.

5.4.5 Privacy Policy and LGPD (General Data Protection Law)

If we collect user data, it will be necessary to implement a privacy policy in accordance with the LGPD (General Data Protection Law). This includes transparency about the collection, storage, and use of data, as well as ensuring that users have control over their personal information. Compliance with the LGPD is essential to avoid legal penalties and strengthen public trust in our company.

5.4.6 Specific Licenses for Sales

We need to be aware of the specific regulations of the platforms where we will distribute our products, including publishing requirements and applicable fees. It is essential to understand and comply with the terms of service of these platforms to ensure compliance and avoid restrictions on the distribution of our products.

5.4.7 Electronic Commerce Regulations

If we choose to sell directly to consumers through our own platform, we must comply with e-commerce regulations. This includes rules regarding returns, providing clear information to consumers, and ensuring the security of financial transactions, guaranteeing a reliable and legally secure experience for our customers.

Meeting these regulations and licenses not only ensures that our startup operates within the law but also strengthens our credibility in the market. This will help build a solid reputation with our customers and partners. To ensure full compliance, it will be crucial to rely on the support of specialized professionals, such as lawyers and legal consultants, to assist us in this process.

6. Legal Aspects

In the development of our startup, it is essential to address various legal aspects, particularly regarding the protection of intellectual property (IP). This protection ensures that our creative works, products, and innovations are legally safeguarded, preventing unauthorized use or reproduction.

6.1 Intellectual Property Protection

In the process of structuring our company, we understand that intellectual property protection is crucial to ensure the security of our innovations and brands, as well as to guarantee that we do not infringe on third-party rights in accordance with the Trademark Registration Law (Law No. 9.279/1996), the Patent Law (Law No. 9.279/1996), the Copyright Law (Law No. 9.610/1998), the Trade Marketing and Competition Law (Law No. 12.529/2011), the Confidentiality Law (Law No. 10.406/2002), and the INPI Regulations. Below, we present the guidelines we will follow to manage intellectual property protection and ensure compliance with relevant legislation.

6.1.1 Trademark registration

We recognize the importance of registering our brand as a valuable asset for our business. To ensure this protection, we will take the following actions:

- **Trademark Registration:** We will register our brand with the **National Institute of Industrial Property (INPI)** to guarantee exclusive use of the brand nationwide.
- **Monitoring:** We will continuously monitor the market for any potential infringements or similar brand registrations that may cause confusion.

By taking these steps, we aim to secure and protect our brand identity, ensuring its strength and exclusivity in the marketplace.

6.1.2 Patents

We are aware that patents are essential for protecting our inventions and innovations. Therefore, we will adopt the following practices:

- **Identification of Patentable Inventions:** We will continuously evaluate our products and processes to identify inventions that may be patentable.

- **Patent Registration:** We will begin the patent registration process with the INPI (National Institute of Industrial Property), a Brazilian institute, ensuring the necessary legal protection for our innovations.
- **Confidentiality:** We will establish confidentiality agreements with employees and partners to protect sensitive information during the development of new technologies.

6.1.3 Copyrights

Copyright protection is crucial to safeguard our intellectual works, such as texts, images, and computer programs. To achieve this, we will implement the following actions:

- **Registration of Works:** We will register our works with the Copyright Office, ensuring ownership and protection against unauthorized copies.
- **Licensing and Usage:** We will establish clear licensing agreements when using third-party works, ensuring that we have the right to use them

6.1.4 Trade Marketing

In the context of trade marketing, it is essential that we respect fair competition rules and do not infringe on the intellectual property rights of others. To achieve this, we will adopt the following practices

- **Competitor Analysis:** We will conduct a detailed analysis of competitors' marketing and trade marketing practices, ensuring that we do not use elements that may infringe on copyrights or registered trademarks.
- **Team Training:** We will conduct regular training sessions with our team to ensure that everyone is aware of the intellectual property laws and the best practices to be followed.

We are committed to adopting a proactive approach to protecting our intellectual property and ensuring compliance with legal regulations. This approach not only protects our assets but also strengthens our reputation in the market. By following these guidelines, we will ensure that our company operates ethically and respectfully, avoiding the infringement of third-party intellectual property rights.

By dedicating ourselves to protecting our innovations and brands, we will be positioned to grow sustainably and responsibly in the market.

6.2 Privacy Policy and LGPD (General Data Protection Law)

Our company is committed to protecting user data and privacy in compliance with the General Data Protection Law (LGPD) – Law No. 13.709/2018, a Brazilian law, as well as other applicable regulations such as the Marco Civil da Internet – Law No. 12.965/2014 and the Consumer Defense Code – Law No. 8.078/1990.

Although we do not intend to collect user registration information, we emphasize our commitment to transparency and digital security should this occur or in other situations, ensuring that any interaction within our games respects the principles of privacy and data protection.

7. Governance

7.1 Introduction to Governance

Flare Dynamic Art adopts a governance model aimed at establishing a clear, ethical, and efficient structure for decision-making. Our approach emphasizes transparency, shared responsibility, and sustainable growth. As a creative startup in its early stages, we seek to balance agility and organization while fostering a collaborative and innovative environment.

7.2 Governance Model

The company follows a horizontal governance model based on collective management among its four founding partners. Instead of fixed hierarchical roles, all partners share equal responsibility in the execution and decision-making processes.

Two main operational spheres guide our activities:

- **Development Sphere:** covers game programming, game design, narrative, art, sound, and user experience.
- **Business Sphere:** involves strategic planning, marketing, legal foundations, financial management, partnerships, and customer relationships.

Despite these thematic areas, all partners remain equally involved across all dimensions of the company, ensuring a unified and integrated execution of tasks.

7.3 Roles and Responsibilities

All founding partners are jointly responsible for all activities related to the company's operation and development. There is no fixed division of labor.

Roles are defined at the beginning of each sprint, during the Sprint Planning session, in line with the project's priorities and the availability and competencies of each partner at the time. This ensures flexibility, autonomy, and adaptability throughout the development process.

Examples of roles that may be assigned during a sprint include:

- **Developer** – Focuses on implementing game mechanics, logic, and code optimization.
- **Game Designer** – Designs rules, balancing systems, levels, and user experience.
- **2D/3D Artist** – Creates visuals, animations, environments, and graphic assets.

- **Writer / Sound Designer** – Develops narrative structure, characters, dialogues, and soundscapes.
- **Business Strategist** – Handles financial planning, documentation, marketing, and partnerships.

7.4 Policies and Processes

7.4.1 Ethics and Transparency

- The company is committed to inclusive, ethical, and responsible practices.
- All meetings, decisions, and progress are documented using shared tools (Google Docs, Sheets, Drive).

7.4.2 Conflict Management

- Internal conflicts are resolved in formal meetings with written summaries (meeting minutes).
- Strategic divergences are discussed collectively and resolved by consensus or simple majority.

7.4.3 Risk Management

- Risks are regularly identified and discussed in sprint meetings.
- Preventive measures and mitigation plans are incorporated into each sprint cycle.

7.5 Accountability and Transparency

- Monthly reports are shared among all partners to monitor production and finances.
- All project management tools and documentation are accessible to the entire team in real time.
- Budget and expenses are openly tracked using shared spreadsheets.

7.6 Compliance and Legal Framework

- The company is registered as an LTDA under the Simples Nacional regime.
- A formal operating agreement (social contract) is being developed to define ownership and responsibilities.
- Flare Dynamic Art follows applicable regulations regarding data privacy (LGPD), intellectual property, and game publishing.

7.7 Social and Cultural Responsibility

- The company's mission is to create cultural and educational impact through interactive digital experiences.
- We uphold values of inclusion, accessibility, diversity, and critical thinking in both content and practices.
- Games developed by Flare are designed to promote reflection and social awareness.

7.8 Governance Maturity Plan

As the company evolves, governance structures will be reviewed and expanded. Planned developments include:

- Formation of an advisory board with industry professionals.
- Implementation of formal compliance policies and internal audits.
- Creation of performance evaluation frameworks for strategic improvement.

8. Angel Investment Proposal

The project consists of the development and release of an independent digital game, focused on distribution through Steam and other digital platforms.

The goal is to create a product of high technical and artistic quality, with a strong visual identity and engaging narrative, capable of generating financial return and strengthening the studio's brand within the indie market.

The game is being developed by **Flare Dynamic Art Studio**, a small creative collective dedicated to the production of original games, emphasizing unique art, original soundtrack, and storytelling.

In addition to the game itself, the project includes the creation of an engaged community from the early stages through a **crowdfunding campaign**, which will complement the angel investment. This initial phase will enable shared funding and help build a loyal fanbase that will follow the development and release of the product.

8.1 Investment Structure

- **Angel Investment Amount:** R\$ 100,000.00
- **Complementary Goal (Crowdfunding):** Variable, depending on campaign engagement
- **Development Period:** 36 to 48 months (3 to 4 years)
- **Model:** Capital investment to fund development and ensure participation in profits after release, according to contract.

Estimated Resource Allocation

Area	Percentage	Amount (R\$)	Notes
Development and Technical Direction	40%	40,000	Programming, technical design, and QA
Art, Soundtrack, and Script	25%	25,000	Illustration, modeling, sound, and narrative
Marketing and Promotion (final year)	25%	25,000	Media campaigns and influencer partnerships
Strategic Reserve / Contingency	10%	10,000	Unexpected or emergency costs
Total	100%	100,000	

During the development phase, there are no fixed costs related to company registration (CNPJ), accountant, or payroll (CLT).

The formal establishment of the company will take place at the time of the game's release, ensuring that the entire investment is directed toward **production, promotion, and commercial structuring**.

8.2 Commercial Assumptions

Sale Price: R\$ 59.99

Steam Fee: 30% ($\approx$ R\$ 18.00 per unit)

Taxes (15.5% inclusive): $\approx$ R\$ 8,06 per unit

Net Revenue per Unit: $\approx$ R\$ 33,94

In addition to direct game sales, there is a monetization strategy including licensed physical products (t-shirts, notebooks, pens, and an art book based on the game universe), as well as the official soundtrack, which will be released before the full game.

8.3 Break-Even Point

To recover the initial investment of R\$ 100,000.00, it will be necessary to sell approximately:

2947 copies

($\text{R\$ } 100,000 \div \text{R\$ } 30.99 \approx 2947$ units)

This volume is considered feasible for independent games with strong presence on platforms like **Steam** and **itch.io**, especially when supported by digital marketing campaigns and community engagement initiated through crowdfunding.

8.4 Return Projection

Below is the updated projection using the correct net revenue per copy (R\$ 33.94):

Scenario	Copies Sold	Net Revenue (R\$)	Return on Investment
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Conservative	5,000	169,700	+69.7%
Moderate	10,000	339,400	+239.4%
Optimistic	20,000	678,800	+578.8%

8.5 Marketing Strategy

Total Investment: R\$ 25,000 (final year)

Main Channels: YouTube, TikTok, Instagram, and Google Ads

Planned Actions:

- Early DEMO release for crowdfunding backers, as an engagement and marketing strategy;
- Creation and maintenance of an active community on social media;
- Collaborations with influencers and streamers;
- Paid campaigns and organic content to boost visibility;
- Gradual launch strategy based on community feedback.

8.6 Investor Return Structure — Profit Sharing Model

The investor will receive returns through a **profit-sharing model**, aligned with the actual commercial performance of *Trail to Elenki*. This structure ensures transparency, risk sharing, and scalability as the game grows.

Profit Distribution

- The investor will receive **X% of the net profit** generated by the game.
- *Net profit* is defined as the revenue obtained after platform fees (e.g., Steam), taxes, and operational costs directly related to the game's distribution.

Payment Frequency

- Profit distributions will be made **quarterly**, accompanied by a financial performance report with detailed revenue and expense breakdowns.

Duration of Payments

The investor will receive profit shares until one of the following conditions is met:

1. **The investor receives up to 150% of the initial investment, or**
2. **A period of 36 months (3 years) of profit sharing has elapsed,**
whichever occurs first.

Transparency and Control

All profit calculations will be documented and stored using project accounting tools, ensuring full traceability. The investor will have access to quarterly statements summarizing sales, expenses, and profit distributions.

8.7 Investment Justification

The proposed funding will:

- Finance full development alongside crowdfunding, avoiding the need for additional funding rounds;
- Support the release of an exclusive DEMO for backers, strengthening the community and the studio's digital presence;
- Expand revenue sources through physical and digital products;
- Ensure high production quality and market readiness.

The studio will be officially registered upon the game's release, guaranteeing that all funds are applied directly to **development and promotion**.

This project offers a **strategic and transparent investment opportunity** in the independent games market.

Flare Dynamic Art studio presents a solid development plan with a viable schedule and sustainable return potential.

The **R\$ 100,000.00 investment**, combined with community support through crowdfunding, will drive the game's development, fund marketing engagement, enable a DEMO release, and build a loyal fanbase for the commercial launch—enhancing both financial returns and brand growth in the digital entertainment market.

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